

Telecommunications – the master weaver

- Commercial space connectivity using low-earth orbits (LEO) is expected to become mainstream in 2026. Deloitte predicts that the number of LEO satellites will touch between 15,000 and 18,000 this year, connecting over 15 million global subscribers.
- The integration of satellite connectivity with terrestrial telecom networks will provide seamless connectivity to users across the globe, especially covering underserved remote areas.
- While 5G will continue its run, we are likely to see the foundations of 6G shaping up with technical specifications and roadmaps.
- Increased interest in IoT will boost demand for low-power wide area networks, which will be crucial for smart city and Industry 4.0 projects.



Beyond the earthly realm – satellites and rockets galore

- Every country is wooing outer space now – and will continue to invest in space missions.
- There will be more focus on developing manufacturing and launch facilities.
- We are likely to see improvements and innovations related to in-space manoeuvrability and on-orbit fuelling.
- The industry is seeing value in non-earth imaging – that is, gathering images of other satellites in space – to help plan satellite distribution across different orbits
- Countries will start establishing governance structures for safe operations, and debris and traffic management in outer space.
- Governments and industry must jointly figure out how to handle cyber risks and national security concerns related to misuse of satellite communication, imagery, and space occupation over a country's territory.
- AI will be increasingly used to help process the data from satellites and spacecrafts more effectively. It will also help astronauts with tasks related to monitoring, predictive maintenance, and troubleshooting.

